AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS X

ANNUAL EXAMINATIONS (THEORY) 2023

English Compulsory Paper II

Time: 2 hours Marks: 45

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INSTRUCTIONS

Please read the following instructions carefully.

1. Check your name and school information. Sign if it is accurate.

I agree that this is my name and school. **Candidate's Signature**

RUBRIC

2. There are THREE questions. Answer ALL questions. Question 2 offers TWO choices and Question 3 offers THREE choices. Attempt any ONE of the options in each.

3. When answering the questions:

   Read each question carefully.
   Use a black pointer to write your answers. DO NOT write your answers in pencil.
   DO NOT use staples, paper clips, glue, correcting fluid or ink erasers.
   Complete your answer in the allocated space only. DO NOT write outside the answer box.

4. The marks for the questions are shown in brackets ( ).

Q.1. (Total 17 Marks)

Read the passage carefully and answer all the questions that follow:

Reading Passage I

For over four years, Andrzej Sapkowski has been one of those authors that has been dangled in front of me, mentioned in passing by Polish readers here and elsewhere, along with an occasional mention on a couple of non-English-language sites that I frequent on occasion. What I read was intriguing enough for me to want more. I looked into buying the Spanish-language editions, but the shipping costs were too prohibitive for me to import from Spain and I never could find any available in American online stores. So I waited. And waited some more, fearing that Sapkowski might never be published in English translation. Until last year, when I heard that Gollancz, perhaps influenced by the upcoming '*The Witcher*' game, was to publish some of Sapkowski's work in English translation for the United Kingdom (UK) market. '*The Last Wish*' is the first of those works to be published in English.

'*The Last Wish*' is a slender, 280-page collection of six loosely-connected short stories and intervals starring Geralt. Originally released in 1993 in Poland as *Ostatnie Zyczenie*, '*The Last Wish*' contains some of the oldest of the Geralt tales, although it was not the first Geralt book released in Poland. It is, however, an excellent introduction to the character and to the type of story that Sapkowski apparently wants to tell.

Although Geralt is trained as a killer and does have some impressive skills as a fighter, violence is not a staple of these stories. Each of these stories have moments like this, moments where Geralt shows that his greatest strength is not in how fast he can kill a monster or how quickly he can evade an attack, but rather in how he is able to take a keener look than his companions at what is truly at stake.

There are many elements of Slavic mythology*, from various creatures that do not have exact similarities in Western mythologies to codes of behaviour, that make this collection a bit more mysterious to me. I suspect there are a few elements that would be funny to a Polish or other Eastern European-reading audience, but which might be taken more literally by the likes of me, born and raised on Western European and Southern mythologies.

*Slavic mythology: a collection of myths belonging to the Slavs (Indo-European people)

Source: Adapted from an article by Holly Grimdragon

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a. '*The Last Wish*' targets Polish or Eastern European audiences (readers) as mentioned in the given passage.

Based on the information in the given passage, will the book interest Pakistani audiences? Mention FOUR reasons to justify your opinion. (4 Marks)

b. Describe any THREE ways in which the author has used logic (reasons) in the given passage. (6 Marks)

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c.

i. Which aspect of the given passage would you have elaborated upon? (1 Mark)

ii. Describe a reason for elaborating the chosen aspect in part (i). (2 Marks)

d. Describe the general idea of the given passage in TWO points. (4 Marks)

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Q.2. (Total 10 Marks)

Compose a response of about 200-250 words to any **ONE** of the options **a or b**.

EITHER

a. During your school's break time, you decided to visit the school canteen to buy food. Upon eating it, you found a fly in it.

Write an email of complaint to your school principal. In your email,

- describe the incident and the consequence.
- propose a solution to the problem.

OR

b. There has been a rise in cyberbullying in recent times. Cyberbullying is a form of bullying or harassment using electronic means.

Write a report to the Editor of your school magazine. In your report, describe a

- consequence of cyberbullying.
- way in which cyberbullying can be controlled.

Make your notes below or on the pages given for rough work. Write your final draft on pages 6 and 7.

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Option _____

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Q.3. (Total 18 Marks)

Write a composition of about 200-300 words on any **ONE** of the options **a, b or c**.
Remember to compose the final draft in complete sentences.

EITHER

a. Write an essay reflecting on your childhood. In your essay, describe

- an important event from your childhood.
- the surroundings you spent your childhood in.
- how the events and/ or surroundings developed you as a person.

OR

b. In recent times, people are often found looking into their smartphones texting others, playing games and browsing through various sites. This is believed to be causing communication gaps among people.

Compose an essay. In your essay,

- state your opinion on the use of smartphones.
- justify your opinion in TWO points.
- discuss whether the use of smartphones is creating communication gaps between people in TWO points.

OR

c. The best way for a society to prepare its young people for success in government, industry, or other fields is by instilling in them a sense of cooperation, not competition.

Compose an essay. In your essay,

- take a stance on the importance of cooperation and/ or competition.
- justify your stance by giving FOUR reasons and/ or examples.

Make your notes below or on the pages given for rough work. Write your final draft on pages 9 and 10.

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Option _____

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END OF PAPER

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